fallow/barren land. Crops contribute about 50 per cent of agricultural GVA, horticultural crops another 20 per cent and animal husbandry the remaining 30 per cent. This makes land productivity quite different within the agricultural group as well. Field crops use 85 per cent of land to produce 50 per cent of output value added, horticultural crops use 15 per cent of land to produce 20 per cent of output value added and animal husbandry uses almost no land to produce 30 per cent of output value added.

Fourth, agriculture uses 80 per cent of India's available water to produce 15 per cent of GDP. Water use in agriculture is grossly inefficient whereas a lot of people in the country do not have adequate drinking water and industry is starved of water to produce higher value addition.

Fifth, renowned demographer and economist Malthus was a false god who surmised that food supply would not be able to expand in the ratio of the expansion of population. The world has shown that food supply can expand to take care of expanding population. In fact, global food supply is now expanding faster than the expansion in population. In India, too, while agriculture has grown on average at over 3 per cent per annum for many years, the population is now growing at less than 1.1 per cent per annum; it is expected to fall below 1 per cent soon.

Sixth, there are too many workers (farmers and landless workers) 'employed' in agriculture. The same level of output can be easily achieved by one-fifth of workers. Overemployment of workers in farming leads to very low wages and income for workers and farmers, which explains the perpetuation of poverty in agricultural and rural areas.

Agriculture policy reforms have to be built around these critical facts.

Reorganize India's Agriculture in 125 Million Hectares

The non-agricultural part of the Indian economy needs more land at lower prices to build industrial areas, set up cities, develop infrastructure and increase India's green spaces. Agriculture has a lot of slack. The ratio of